

board is kept in its anti-static packaging until the time of installation.

3 Setting the jumpers before installing it

Set the jumpers to their correct positions before installing the motherboard into the system cabinet. Doing this lessens your chances of missing any critical settings and it is also far easier to access certain jumpers when the board is outside the system.

4 Mount the processor and RAM before installing

It can be quite difficult to mount the processor, especially the heatsink, after the board is seated in the cabinet, since the power and IDE cables get in the way. Therefore, mount the processor, the heatsink and fan and the RAM modules when the motherboard is outside the system. This also allows you to visually verify if the heatsink is properly seated on the processor.

Remember to connect the CPU fan to the correct point on the motherboard.

5 Ensure a comfortable fit

The power conditioning capacitors next to the processor socket can get in the way of mounting the CPU heatsink. Make sure that your heatsink does not push against these, as this could damage or even dislodge them from the motherboard. Also, in the case of special

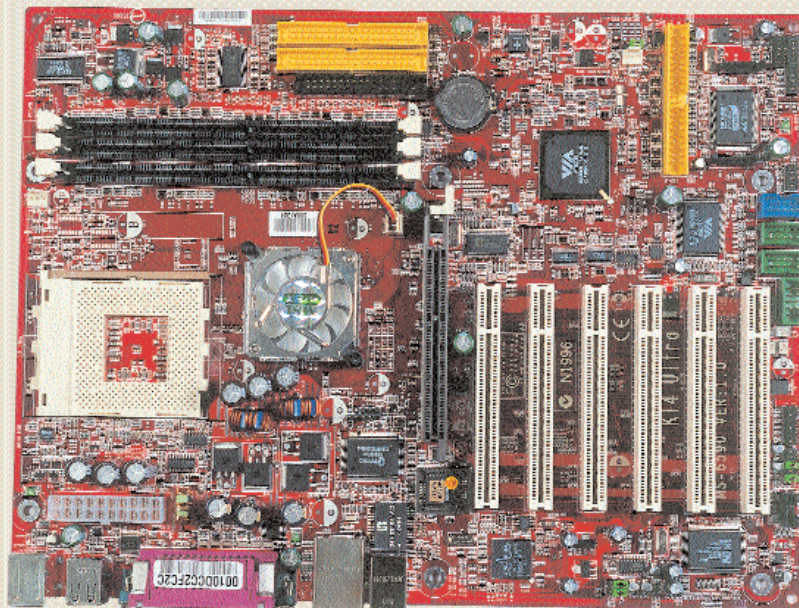
heatsinks, verify that it is not large enough to push against other surface mounted components close to the processor socket.

6 Anchoring the board

Make sure that your motherboard is comfortably seated in the cabinet. Preferably, your cabinet should have a detachable backplate—this lets you mount the motherboard using the spacers and mounting screws outside the system. Ensure that the motherboard has anchor points near all the extremities of the board so that it will be firmly seated and all its edges are adequately supported.

7 Tighten later

Most of the time, one would tighten all the screws of the motherboard upon placing it into the system. A better option is to lightly fasten all the mounting screws so that there is still a bit of play in the motherboard after it has been mounted. Tighten the motherboard's mounting screws after the rest of the add-on cards have been placed in their respective PCI or AGP slots. This helps alle-



Some boards, like this MSI KT4 Ultra, include a fan for its chipset—something to look out for

viate any unnecessary build-up of stress by cards that might have been forced into a slot.

8 Take care while attaching the IDE cables

The IDE cables are usually situated near one edge of the motherboard. Therefore, care needs to be taken that the board is not bent when plugging in the ends of the cables. This could cause breakages in the delicate tracks on the motherboard's surface, rendering it useless.

9 Attach the CPU fan

This cannot be stressed enough—ensure that the CPU fan is plugged into the correct point on the motherboard. Failing to do so could result in your CPU

and motherboard being permanently damaged—and all this could happen within seconds of powering up the system, leaving you with absolutely no time to correct your mistake!

10 Listen for diagnostic beeps

Remember to connect the motherboard speaker. Study the motherboard manual for deciphering the sequence of the diagnostic beeps that are emitted when the motherboard is powered up—a single short beep means things are in order. Otherwise, you need to diagnose what's wrong with the help of the beep sequence. Check if all fans are spinning, and that the cards and RAM modules are properly seated.

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